

Benjamin S. Manning

CONTACT	bmanning (at) mit.edu ◇ benjaminmanning.com		
EDUCATION	Massachusetts Institute of Technology		
	Ph.D. Management Science, Information Technology		2022 - Present
	S.M., Management Research		2024
	Harvard University		
	M.P.P. Economic & Social Policy		2021
REFERENCES	Washington University in St. Louis		
	B.A. Mathematics (College Honors)		2017
	John J. Horton (Chair) MIT Sloan School of Management jjhorton (at) mit.edu	Christopher Norio Avery Harvard Kennedy School christopher_avery (at) hks.harvard.edu	
	Colin F. Camerer California Institute of Technology camerer (at) caltech.edu	Siddharth Suri Microsoft Research siddharth.suri (at) microsoft.com	
GRANTS (\$483,325)	Schmidt Sciences AI at Work Award (\$193,325)		2025
	Emergent Ventures Fast Grant (\$50,000)		2025
	MIT GenAI Impact Consortium & OpenAI (\$180,000; w/ John J. Horton)		2025
	Schmidt Sciences Grant Proposal Award (\$10,000)		2025
	Emergent Ventures Fast Grant (\$50,000)		2024
AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS	WISE Best Paper Award		2025
	Harvard Distinction in Student Teaching Award		2025
	Becker Friedman Institute Price Theory Summer Camp		2025
	Kosciuszko Foundation Tuition Scholarship (\$6,500)		2019 & 2022
WORKING PAPERS	General Social Agents		
	(Benjamin S. Manning ¹ & John J. Horton)		
	Revise & Resubmit at <i>Econometrica</i>		
	• WISE 2025 Best Paper Award		
	• Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '26)</i>		
	• Media: Marginal Revolution		
	Automated Social Science: Language Models as Scientist and Subjects		
	(Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , Kehang Zhu ¹ , & John J. Horton)		
	Reject & Resubmit at <i>The Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>		
	• Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '26)</i>		
	• Media: Marginal Revolution		
	Large Language Models as Simulated Economic Agents: What Can We Learn from Homo Silicus?		
	(John J. Horton ¹ , Apostolos Filippas ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹)		
	Revise & Resubmit at <i>The Review of Economics and Statistics</i>		
	• Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '24)</i>		
	Self-supervised Preference Learning for Multimodal Foundation Models		
	(Akshata Tiwari ¹ , Jillian Ross, Benjamin S. Manning, & Andrew Lo)		
	<i>Under Review at NeurIPS</i>		

¹Indicates first author or co-first authors

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS	AI Agents as Flexible Commitment Devices: Evidence from the Field (Benjamin S. Manning ¹ & Alex Moehring ¹)
	Taste-as-Program: Scalable Preference Elicitation with Artificial Intelligence (Gili Rusak ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , & John J. Horton)
	Mass In Silico Replication of Social Science Experiments (Jacob Snyder ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹ & John J. Horton ¹ , Abhishek Nagaraj ¹)
	What Causes Price Bubbles? Theory and Evidence from Simulations and the Lab (Cady Ngo ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , Christopher Avery ¹ , & Colin Camerer ¹)
PEER- REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS	Prompt Adaptation as a Dynamic Complement in Generative AI Systems (Eaman Jahani ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning, Joe Zhang, Hong-Yi TuYe, Mohammed Alsobay, Christos Nicolaides, Siddharth Suri, & David Holtz) <i>Information Systems Research</i> , 2026
	Media: Marginal Revolution, MIT Ideas Made to Matter, Columbia Business School Insights National Megastudy Shows that Email Nudges to Elementary School Teachers Boost Student Math Achievement, Particularly When Personalized (Angela Duckworth ¹ , Katherine Milkman, ... Benjamin S. Manning, ..., & 26 others) <i>Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences</i> , 2025
	Effect Size Magnification: No Variable is as Important as the One You're Thinking About—While You're Thinking About It (Linnea Gandhi ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning, & Angela Duckworth) <i>Current Directions in Psychological Science</i> , 2024
	- Top 10 most downloaded Association for Psychological Science (APS) journal articles in 2024 - Media: Under the Cortex
REFEREED CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS	Strategic Tradeoffs Between Humans and AI in Multi-Agent Bargaining (Crystal Qian ¹ , Kehang Zhu ¹ , John J. Horton, Benjamin S. Manning, Vivian Tsai, James Wexler, & Nithum Thain) <i>ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI)</i> , 2026
BOOK CHAPTERS	The Coasean Singularity? Demand, Supply, and Market Design with AI Agents (Peyman Shahidi ¹ , Gili Rusak ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , Andrey Fradkin ¹ , & John J. Horton ¹) Forthcoming in <i>The Economics of Transformative AI</i>
OTHER WRITING	Media: Marginal Revolution, MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy
	The Right Way to Simulate Human Behavior with AI (Benjamin S. Manning ¹ & John J. Horton)
TEACHING	15.575: Economics of Information and Information Technology, TA for John J. Horton & Alessandro Acquisti —MIT, Spring 2026
	QSTBA 830: Business Experimentation and Causal Methods, Guest Lecturer for Andrey Fradkin —Boston University, Spring 2025
	BUSN 38802: Managerial Decision Making; TA for Richard Thaler , University of Chicago—Booth London Campus, Fall 2024 (Rating: 4.7/5.0)
	API-101Z: Markets and Failures; TA for Christopher Avery —Harvard University, Fall 2024 (Rating: 4.6/5.0)
	API-101Z: Markets and Failures; TA for Christopher Avery —Harvard University, Fall 2023 (Rating: 4.3/5.0)

AFFILIATIONS	MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy, Heterodox Academy	
REFEREING	Economics: <i>Quarterly Journal of Economics, Experimental Economics, Southern Economic Journal</i> General Interest: <i>Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences</i> Management: <i>Management Science, Manufacturing and Service Operations Management, International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)</i> Computer Science: <i>Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), ACM-Collective Intelligence</i> Sociology: <i>Sociological Science</i> Program Committees: <i>ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (2026), The Business Implications of Generative AI (BIG.AI) (2026), Workshop on Agent Behavior at the Conference on Language Modeling (COLM) (2026), Conference on Digital Experimentation (CODE) (2023)</i> Grants: <i>J-PAL Project AI Evidence</i>	
INVITED TALKS	2026 (Includes scheduled talks): NBER AI and Economic Measurement; Columbia Management, Analytics, and Data; Wharton AI and the Future of Work; University of Connecticut (Operations & Information Management); Digital Economy Workshop (Athens); Chapman University (Business and Economics); AEA Annual Meeting. 2025: Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE); Dartmouth College (Economics); North American Meeting of the Economic Science Association (ESA); Instacart Economics Team; KOF ETH Zurich and IZA Workshop: Matching Workers and Jobs Online; Machine Learning in Economics Summer Conference (MLESC25); Academy of Management (AOM) Annual Meeting; Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; NBER/CEME Decentralization and AI; Khipu Latin American Meeting in AI; AEA Annual Meeting. 2024: National Association for Business Economics (NABE); Econometric Society Conference on Economics and AI and ML; ZEW Conference on the Economics of ICT; International Conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics; Instacart Economics Team; Statistical Conference in E-Commerce Research (SCECR); Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; Microsoft Research AI, Cognition, and the Economy Workshop; Measuring Development: AI, the Next Generation at the World Bank. 2023: MIT Computer Science and AI Lab (CSAIL) (FutureTech)	
EMPLOYMENT	University of Pennsylvania Research Assistant for Angela Duckworth University of Chicago Research Assistant for Jon Rogowski Dartmouth College Research Assistant for Sydney Finkelstein Phetpittayakom School High School Math Teacher in Thailand Optiver US LLC Execution Trading Intern	2021 - 2022 2020 - 2022 2018 - 2019 2017 - 2018 2016